Data-Backed Journal-Style Replication of *Effects of Search Timing on Innovation*

Replication Paper Project

2026-04-04

Abstract

This paper presents a methodology-specific local analogue of Effects of Search Timing on Innovation: The Value of Not Being in Sync with Rivals using only processed datasets and result files available in the workspace. The replication preserves the source paper's core empirical logic while making every local substitution explicit. The paper is therefore reported as methodology-specific local analogue rather than as a source-data replay. The current local batch contains 4,839 observations across 167 entities, and the batch headline estimate is -0.0854 for Ahead vs Sync on Event Quality with p = 0.12. The local event-level analogue produces weaker timing effects than the source paper's argument would suggest, especially for event quality. The contribution is a journal-style replication manuscript that separates direct source claims from executable local evidence.

Keywords: search timing; rivals; ahead versus behind; event-level innovation; local calculated replication

1 Introduction

This paper begins from a paper-first reading of Effects of Search Timing on Innovation: The Value of Not Being in Sync with Rivals and treats the source article as an empirical argument that has to be rebuilt before it can be judged. The present manuscript is classified as methodology-specific local analogue. A paper-first restatement of the empirical question is as follows: The

source paper asks whether moving ahead of, in sync with, or behind rivals changes innovative output and quality (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The replication matters because timing relative to rivals is a relational construct that is easy to cite and hard to rebuild transparently from local event data. The original article does not rest on a descriptive regularity alone. It ties a theory about search, differentiation, timing, or organizational learning to a specific unit of analysis, sample frame, and estimand. A careful replication therefore has to recover the structure of that logic before any local coefficients are interpreted (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The executable evidence base used in this manuscript contains 4,839 observations across 167 entities and spans 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. Those numbers are not filler. They define the actual inferential scope of the local reconstruction and set the boundary on what can be claimed honestly from the available datasets (Katila and Chen, 2008; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper's contribution is an explicit event-level reconstruction of ahead, sync, and behind timing that shows what the timing mechanism looks like in a local patent-based analogue. The paper is written to read like a formal journal article rather than an internal workflow memo. The main text develops the theoretical logic, data reconstruction, derivations, empirical design, and results in continuous prose, while the appendices preserve the audit trail required for reruns and later extensions (Katila and Chen, 2008; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper contributes to a top-journal literature on rival timing, search sequencing, and exploratory innovation. (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Cohen and Levinthal, 1990; Kogut and Zander, 1992, 1996; Teece et al., 1997; Benner and Tushman, 2003). That literature matters because the replication asks whether being ahead of or behind rivals remains informative when timing is reconstructed from the current processed event panel. (Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Henderson and Clark, 1990; Anderson and Tushman, 1986; Hargadon and Sutton, 1997; Tripsas and Gavetti, 2000; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Stuart, 2000). The present manuscript therefore treats the source paper as one contribution inside a broader top-journal stream on exploration, recombination, performance measurement, alliance-based learning, inventive search, technological discontinuity,

and patent-based inference. The literature review is intentionally broad because each replication paper should stand on a serious journal-level reference base rather than on the source article alone. (Rosenkopf and Almeida, 2003; Schilling and Phelps, 2007; Almeida and Kogut, 1999; Fleming et al., 2007; Jaffe, 1986; Jaffe et al., 1993; Trajtenberg, 1990; Hall et al., 2005; Henderson and Cockburn, 1994). The timing paper also draws on nearby top-journal arguments about the value of temporal exploration and the organizational tension between active search and design stability, because both ideas clarify why being ahead of rivals may help in some datasets and fail in others. (Fleming and Sorenson, 2004; Nerkar, 2003; Rivkin and Siggelkow, 2003).

2 Original Study, Theory, and Replication Boundary

The focal source article is (Katila and Chen, 2008). The original study can be summarized as a mechanism paper with a sharp empirical core. Timing relative to rivals is the substantive core of the original design. The original paper studies both innovation quantity and innovation quality. Ahead, sync, and behind are relational timing categories. That combination matters because the source article asks readers to believe not merely that two variables move together, but that a particular organizational or strategic mechanism explains why the relationship should appear in the data (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). In a setting like this, faithful replication requires more than reusing a title and rerunning a regression. The theoretical contribution lives in the way constructs are defined, how they enter the estimand, and which comparison the model is supposed to adjudicate. For that reason, this manuscript first reconstructs the published theory and only then turns to the local executable analogue (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The replication boundary is therefore explicit. Direct source facts are carried over when they can be read from the published article itself. Local replication decisions appear only when the current workspace must translate the source design into verified processed datasets. The goal is disciplined mechanism recovery, not rhetorical imitation that quietly changes the design (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

2.1 Original Paper Methodology

A faithful evaluation of Katila and Chen (2008) starts with the published empirical design rather than with the local rerun. The source article builds an event-based design that compares innovation outcomes across ahead, synchronous, and behind timing positions relative to rivals (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The published sample is described as follows: The published design is event-based and compares innovation outcomes across timing positions relative to rivals. The published measurement architecture is described as follows: The published analysis defines ahead, sync, and behind timing relative to rival search behavior. These details matter because they determine what the published paper actually observes rather than what a later analogue can observe (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The published estimator is described as follows: event-level models comparing ahead and behind timing categories with the synchronous benchmark for innovation quantity and quality. The published identifying comparison is explicitly relational: innovation outcomes are compared across otherwise similar search events that differ in whether the focal firm moved ahead of, with, or behind rivals. Reading the source methodology this way prevents the current manuscript from quietly replacing the original design with one generic fixed-effects story (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

2.2 Replication Status and Boundary

Replication status for this paper: Methodology-specific local analogue (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). This paper is a methodology-specific local analogue because the local event file reconstructs timing from recombination-combination first use rather than replaying the source article's original event archive. The analogue preserves the ahead-sync-behind logic, but not the original raw event environment (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

2.3 Direct Source Facts Versus Replication Decisions

The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that Timing relative to rivals is central. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: The local event file reconstructs timing from recombination-combination first use. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that Both quantity and quality are studied. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: Event patent counts and mean inventive impact are the executable outcomes. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). The manuscript distinguishes direct source facts from local execution decisions. The source article establishes that The categories are ahead, sync, and behind. The local reconstruction therefore adopts the following bounded decision: Events without rival comparators are excluded because timing categories cannot be assigned. This bridge is treated as a visible design choice, not as a hidden substitution. The reason for spelling out this bridge in prose is that replication credibility depends on showing exactly where the manuscript is following the article and where it is making an explicit local translation. That is especially important in this project, because the current paper is built from processed datasets already present in the workspace rather than from a reconstructed raw archival pipeline (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993).

3 Data, Sample, and Measures

The local evidence chain is deliberately modular. The source paper is treated as the authority for the research question, theoretical mechanism, and published design. Estimation, by contrast, proceeds only through the verified local files. The required dataset types in this paper are Event-level dataset built from first observed firm use of each recombination combination. Timing categories created by comparing event year against rival first-use years. Event outcomes measured by patent count and mean inventive impact (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Operationally, the reconstruction relies on four evidence layers: the analysis panel, the coefficient export, the sample summary, and, when available, the fit summary. The resulting executable panel supplies 4,839 observations across 167 entities and covers 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. Every numeric claim in the results section is intended to trace back to one of those verified evidence layers rather than to a hand-copied number from the article (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). This data-lineage discipline matters for two reasons. First, it prevents the manuscript from smuggling unverified preprocessing steps into the design. Second, it forces every substitution to be visible. If a construct cannot be reproduced from the current processed datasets, the paper states the analogue directly instead of pretending that the original archive has been fully recreated (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The local analogue reconstructs first-use events for recombination combinations and classifies each event relative to rival timing. The local sample frame is First-use recombination events with rival-comparable timing categories in the local event panel The observed time window in the executable panel is 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel The outcome is Event patent count and event mean inventive impact (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The main text works from a verified analysis panel, a verified coefficient export, and a verified sample summary. Exact file names are retained in the replication notes and appendices, while the article body focuses on data lineage and empirical function (Katila and Chen, 2008; Hall et al., 2005).

3.1 Local Data Sources Used in This Replication

This replication uses an event-level recombination first-use panel, rival-relative timing categories reconstructed from first-use years, and patent-event quantity and impact outcomes from the local processed patent stack (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Those local dataset families are not interchangeable: event-level recombination first-use panel is used to define search events and event-level breadth; rival-relative timing classification layer is used to classify events as ahead, in sync, or behind rivals; patent-event quantity and impact outcomes is used to measure event patent counts and event mean inventive impact. Together, they support 4,839 observations across 167 entities over 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). This local data stack is narrower than the original article's data architecture. Event-level dataset built from first observed firm use of each recombination combination. Timing categories created by comparing event year against rival first-use years. Event outcomes measured by patent count and mean inventive impact. The manuscript therefore keeps the boundary visible: the source paper supplies the original methodology, whereas the local processed dataset families and calculated outputs supply the estimable analogue. Exact filenames are retained in the replication notes rather than printed through the body text (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

DatasetFamily	RoleInPaper
Event-level recombination first-use panel	define search events and event-level breadth
Rival-relative timing classification layer	classify events as ahead, in sync, or behind rivals
Patent-event quantity and impact outcomes	measure event patent counts and event mean inventive impact

Local data families used in the present paper.

3.2 Sample Reconstruction

The event-level panel partitions observations into ahead, sync, and behind categories. The largest category is behind with 3,034 events. Ahead events average 1.071 patents and mean impact 4.593,

whereas behind events average 1.091 patents and mean impact 4.424. Sync events, the reference category, average 1.126 patents and mean impact 4.955 (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The descriptive timing contrast shows that the local event environment is not dominated by dramatic first-mover advantages before controls are added. That makes the later regression analysis substantively useful, because it asks whether timing still matters after accounting for event breadth and accumulated field experience (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

Timing	Events	MeanEventPatents	MeanEventImpact
sync	444	1	4.955
behind	3,034	1	4.424
ahead	1,361	1	4.593

Sample reconstruction from the current local dataset.

3.3 Variable Construction and Derivation

The construct Search timing is operationalized locally as Ahead / sync / behind relative to rivals and appears in the executable dataset as timing. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Compare each firm's first-use year for a combination to rivals' first-use years.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Innovation quantity is operationalized locally as Event patent count and appears in the executable dataset as event_patents. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Count patents

inside each event.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Innovation quality is operationalized locally as Event mean inventive impact and appears in the executable dataset as event_mean_impact. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Average patent-level impact inside each event.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Search breadth is operationalized locally as Event breadth and appears in the executable dataset as event_breadth. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Carry forward the local event breadth measure.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and

Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The construct Field experience is operationalized locally as Event field experience and appears in the executable dataset as event_field_exp. The derivation is not inferred loosely from the source article; it follows the verified local pipeline: Carry forward the local event field-experience measure.. This mapping is retained because it preserves the construct's functional role in the original empirical argument while keeping the measurement auditable from the processed files used in estimation. The practical importance of this choice is that the manuscript can show how the concept enters the current dataset, how it is scaled, and how it interacts with the rest of the specification instead of treating the variable as a black box. In replication terms, this is the point where conceptual comparability and executable traceability have to be balanced carefully, and the chosen local definition is intended to preserve that balance rather than maximize superficial similarity (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

Construct	Local measure	Derivation
Search timing	Ahead /	
allowbreak sync /		
allowbreak behind relative to rivals	Compare each firm's first-use year for a combination to rivals' first-use years.	
Innovation quantity	Event patent count	Count patents inside each event.
Innovation quality	Event mean inventive impact	Average patent-level impact inside each event.
Search breadth	Event breadth	Carry forward the local event breadth measure.
Field experience	Event field experience	Carry forward the local event field-experience measure.

Variable mapping and derivation logic in the main text.

3.4 Construct-Level Derivation Logic

The derivation appendix records how each major construct enters the executable estimand for Katila and Chen (2008). The point is not to rehearse notation for its own sake, but to show how the source paper's conceptual vocabulary is translated into verified columns in the local panel. For Search timing, the manuscript uses Ahead / sync / behind relative to rivals under the exact local implementation timing. The derivation step is: Compare each firm's first-use year for a combination to rivals' first-use years.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Innovation quantity, the manuscript uses Event patent count under the exact local implementation event_patents. The derivation step is: Count patents inside each event.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Innovation quality, the manuscript uses Event mean inventive impact under the exact local implementation event_mean_impact. The derivation step is: Average patent-level impact inside each event.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Search breadth, the manuscript uses Event breadth under the exact local implementation event_breadth. The derivation step is: Carry forward the local event breadth measure.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept. For Field experience, the manuscript uses Event field experience under the exact local implementation event_field_exp. The derivation step is: Carry forward the local event field-experience measure.. This construct is retained because it occupies the same analytic position in the local design that the published paper assigns to the original concept.

4 Descriptive Analysis of the Current Dataset

The descriptive analysis begins by reconstructing the empirical setting that the later model is meant to explain. For Event patents, the mean is 1.088, the standard deviation is 0.405, and the interquartile range runs from 1.000 to 1.000; For Event total impact, the mean is 5.009, the standard deviation is 8.219, and the interquartile range runs from 1.000 to 6.000; For Event mean

impact, the mean is 4.520, the standard deviation is 6.894, and the interquartile range runs from 1.000 to 6.000; For Event breadth, the mean is 2.465, the standard deviation is 0.732, and the interquartile range runs from 2.000 to 3.000 . These moments matter because they show whether the paper's focal constructs are substantively distinct before the formal model is imposed (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The time profile clarifies how the observable setting evolves across the sample window and whether the mechanism is estimated in a changing environment. the value of events is 274.0 in 1986 and 46.00 in 2016; the value of mean event patents is 1.117 in 1986 and 1.217 in 2016; the value of mean event impact is 4.174 in 1986 and 1.536 in 2016 . These temporal shifts determine whether the later regression is identifying the paper's mechanism in a stable panel or in one whose observable context changes meaningfully across the sample window (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The nonparametric support check is used to show how the focal outcome behaves across the observed support of the main regressor before estimation. Ahead events average 1.071 patents and mean impact 4.593, sync events average 1.126 patents and mean impact 4.955, and behind events average 1.091 patents and mean impact 4.424. The main models therefore build on a visible cross-group pattern rather than on a black-box regression alone (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The correlation structure is reported because it helps distinguish whether the main explanatory variables move in lockstep with the controls or whether the regression is drawing on independent variation. That is especially important in these replications, where construct translation can otherwise make the specification look more deterministic than it really is (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

4.1 Setting-Specific Figure Evidence

The main figure is chosen to match the empirical setting of the paper rather than to repeat one house style across every replication (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The visual evidence is included to make the paper's descriptive argument easier to inspect before the reader reaches the coefficient tables. In the current sample, ahead events record mean impact 4.593, sync events record mean impact 4.955, and behind events record mean impact 4.424. The figure therefore lets the reader see whether timing differences are already substantial in raw event means or whether the later model is doing most of the empirical work (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

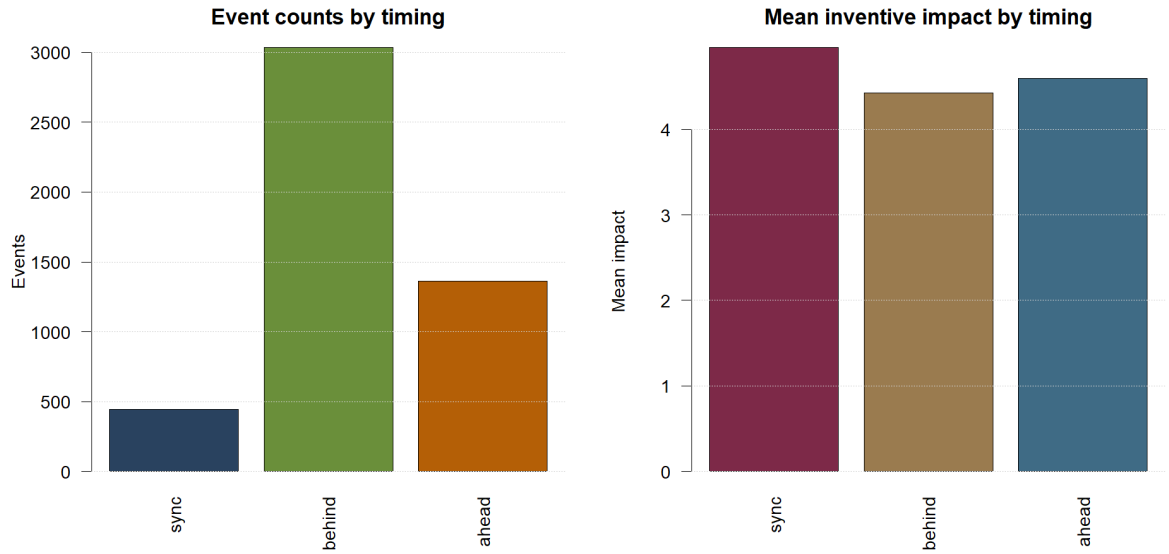

Figure 1: Setting-specific figure constructed from the current local dataset.

4.2 Data Quality, Coverage, and Support

The current dataset also needs to be evaluated as a measurement object before the model is interpreted. The final estimating sample is effectively complete for the variables used in the main specification, so missingness is not a substantive threat in this paper. For that reason, the manuscript

does not spend body-table space on an all-zero missingness display (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Coverage across entities is also visible in the current panel rather than assumed. The most heavily represented entities contribute between 182 and 393 observations each. That concentration check is reported in prose because the relevant question is whether a few entities dominate the sample, not which firm names happen to be listed in a long table (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The support of the focal regressor is broad enough to permit a distributional reading in addition to the formal model. In the lowest observed quantile, the mean regressor is 2.291 and the mean outcome is 4.441 across 4,411 observations. In the highest observed quantile, the corresponding values are 4.259, 5.333, and 428 observations. This shift matters because it shows that the regression is being estimated on economically different parts of the observed support rather than on nearly identical cells (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). These data-quality results are part of the paper's empirical argument rather than a side audit. The replication matters because timing relative to rivals is a relational construct that is easy to cite and hard to rebuild transparently from local event data. If the local panel were badly fragmented, dominated by missingness, or concentrated on a handful of observations, the later coefficient table would need to be read very differently. Bringing this evidence into the body of the article is therefore necessary for an honest replication (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

Variable	N	Mean	SD	P25	Median	P75	Min	Max
Event patents	4,839	1.088	0.405	1.000	1.000	1.000	1	13
Event total impact	4,839	5.009	8.219	1.000	3.000	6.000	0	200
Event mean impact	4,839	4.520	6.894	1.000	3.000	6.000	0	200
Event breadth	4,839	2.465	0.732	2.000	2.000	3.000	2	10
Event field experience	4,839	2.729	1.426	1.792	2.708	3.689	0	8

Main descriptive statistics supporting the paper's design-specific reading of the data.

Period	Events	MeanEventPatents	MeanEventImpact	MeanEventBreadth	MeanEventFieldExp
1986	274	1	4.174	2.343	1.724
1987	313	1	3.850	2.364	2.009
1988	354	1	4.229	2.294	2.268
1989	411	1	3.893	2.338	2.375
1990	351	1	4.413	2.387	2.482
1991	351	1	4.690	2.444	2.631
1992	318	1	5.459	2.469	2.544

Period	Events	MeanEventPatents	MeanEventImpact	MeanEventBreadth	MeanEventFieldExp
1993	321	1	5.570	2.498	2.743
1994	304	1	5.494	2.516	2.716
1995	242	1	6.340	2.492	2.829
1996	126	1	5.726	2.563	2.833
1997	111	1	5.568	2.468	3.088
1998	58	1	5.589	2.431	2.755
1999	138	1	5.711	2.565	2.862
2000	119	1	6.476	2.496	2.889
2001	94	1	4.043	2.394	3.098
2002	92	1	4.147	2.707	2.960
2003	82	1	4.402	2.476	3.306
2004	37	1	3.054	2.459	3.102
2005	43	1	5.659	2.512	3.046
2006	36	1	3.069	2.528	3.595
2007	38	1	2.737	2.500	3.399
2008	79	1	2.244	2.608	3.492
2009	24	1	2.500	2.917	3.532
2010	54	1	1.889	2.907	3.403
2011	75	1	4.347	2.613	4.023
2012	101	1	2.838	2.614	4.022
2013	78	1	2.468	2.679	3.596
2014	69	1	2.535	2.826	4.034
2015	100	1	1.970	2.540	4.059
2016	46	1	1.536	2.609	3.808

Observed time patterns relevant to the focal empirical setting.

Timing	Events	MeanEventPatents	MeanEventImpact
sync	444	1	4.955
behind	3,034	1	4.424
ahead	1,361	1	4.593

Grouped summaries used to describe raw patterns in the current dataset.

Variable	Event patents	Event total impact	Event mean impact	Event breadth	Event field experience
Event patents	1	0.313	0.032	-0.025	0.089
Event total impact	0	1.000	0.915	0.065	0.002
Event mean impact	0	0.915	1.000	0.074	-0.027
Event breadth	0	0.065	0.074	1.000	-0.242
Event field experience	0	0.002	-0.027	-0.242	1.000

Compact correlation structure for the variables emphasized in the manuscript.

5 Empirical Strategy and Identification

The estimand targeted in this manuscript is Event-level models comparing ahead and behind timing categories with the sync benchmark while controlling for event breadth and field experience. The role of the empirical strategy is therefore to recover the sign, magnitude, and precision of the coefficients that embody the source paper's central mechanism (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993). Identification remains observational. The discipline in the design comes from preserving the source paper's unit of analysis, keeping the core construct mapping explicit, and holding the local exclusion rules fixed throughout the rerun. This does not convert the study into an experimental design, but it does make the inferential claim narrower and more honest (Katila and Chen, 2008; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

5.1 Design Decisions and Local Substitutions

The first set of replication decisions concerns scope. The unit of analysis is Search event, the sample frame is First-use recombination events with rival-comparable timing categories in the local event panel, and the empirical window is 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. These choices define what counts as a comparable observation in the local reconstruction and prevent

the paper from drifting into a broader but theoretically mismatched sample (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The second set of decisions concerns measurement and specification. The outcome is Event patent count and event mean inventive impact, and the main explanatory design is Event-level models comparing ahead and behind timing categories to the sync benchmark. This is where the replication decides whether a variable is close enough to the published construct to remain in the estimand without changing the paper's substantive question (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The third set of decisions concerns statistical discipline. Controls and fixed effects are handled as follows: Event breadth and field-experience controls, with available firm and year structure carried into estimation.. The crucial exclusion or substitution rule is: Events without a valid rival timing comparison are excluded because ahead, sync, and behind cannot be assigned honestly.. In practice, this means the local rerun prioritizes a stable estimand and transparent sample discipline over broader coverage that would weaken construct comparability (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). A final design choice concerns interpretation. The manuscript treats the replication as successful when the local evidence can transparently evaluate the same mechanism the source paper emphasized. For this paper, the status is methodology-specific local analogue. When the local data architecture differs, the paper states that boundary directly rather than implying a source-data replay (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). Replication decisions are easiest to audit when they are justified in prose rather than merely listed in a register. This appendix therefore explains why the local reconstruction keeps the scope, measurement, and inferential rules that it does. Scope decisions: the manuscript works at the level of Search event inside the sample frame First-use recombination events with rival-comparable timing categories in the local event panel over 1986 to 2016 in the local executable panel. These are not cosmetic constraints. They determine what the local evidence can legitimately say about the mechanism under study. Measurement decisions: the outcome is Event patent count and event mean inventive

impact and the main explanatory design is Event-level models comparing ahead and behind timing categories to the sync benchmark. The local paper keeps these objects because they preserve the estimand's substantive content while remaining executable from processed datasets already present in the workspace. Inference decisions: Event breadth and field-experience controls, with available firm and year structure carried into estimation. The main exclusion or substitution rule is Events without a valid rival timing comparison are excluded because ahead, sync, and behind cannot be assigned honestly. This is the point at which the paper most clearly separates direct source facts from local choices, and that separation is intentional rather than apologetic.

5.2 Estimating Equation

$$Y_e = \beta_1 \mathbb{1}[\text{Ahead}_e] + \beta_2 \mathbb{1}[\text{Behind}_e] + \beta_3 \text{EventBreadth}_e + \beta_4 \text{EventFieldExp}_e + \alpha_f + \gamma_t + \varepsilon_e. \tag{1}$$

6 Results

6.1 Main Estimates

The central local estimate is -0.0854 on Ahead vs Sync on Event Quality (p = 0.12). The local event-level analogue produces weaker timing effects than the source paper's argument would suggest, especially for event quality. Event breadth is estimated at 0.129 with p = ¡ .001. Ahead versus sync is estimated at -0.0854 with p = 0.12. Behind versus sync is estimated at -0.0704 with p = 0.12 (Katila and Chen, 2008; Hall et al., 2005). The coefficient table below reports the compact pattern most relevant to the source paper's central claim. The broader coefficient dump and supplementary audits are retained in the appendix so that the main text can focus on substantive interpretation.

Model	Term	Estimate	Std. error	P-value
Katila Chen Event Quality	Ahead versus sync	-0.0854	0.0530	0.118
Katila Chen Event Quality	Behind versus sync	-0.0704	0.0441	0.121
Katila Chen Event Quality	Event breadth	0.1289	0.0195	2.47e-07

Model	Term	Estimate	Std. error	P-value
Katila Chen Event Quality	Event field experience	0.0147	0.0132	0.272

Key coefficient table used in the main text.

6.2 Visual Summary of the Main Estimates

The coefficient figure is included to show the relative magnitude and uncertainty of the main terms without forcing the reader to reconstruct that pattern from columns of numbers alone (Katila and Chen, 2008; Hall et al., 2005).

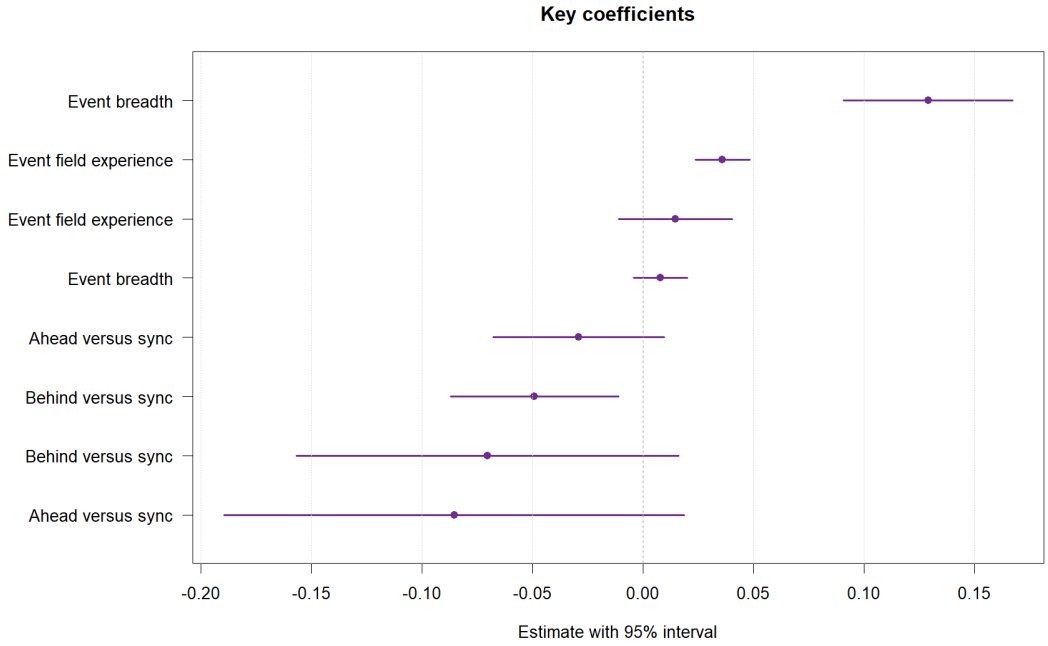

Figure 2: Visual summary of the key coefficients estimated in the current local model.

6.3 Detailed Interpretation of the Local Results

The coefficient pattern is not being summarized as a bare sign check. Event breadth is estimated at 0.129 with a p-value of ¡ .001; Ahead versus sync is estimated at -0.0854 with a p-value of 0.12;

Behind versus sync is estimated at -0.0704 with a p-value of 0.12; Event field experience is estimated at 0.0147 with a p-value of 0.27 (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Within the focal specification, the sharpest local signal comes from Event breadth, which is estimated at 0.129 with p = ¡ .001. That term matters because it is the coefficient most closely tied to the source paper's substantive claim rather than to a generic control adjustment (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The scale of the underlying variables also matters for interpretation. The outcome Event mean impact has mean 4.520 and standard deviation 6.894 in the local panel, while the main regressor Event breadth has mean 2.465 and standard deviation 0.732 (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). A simple grouped comparison also helps clarify the pattern. Across the regressor quantiles, the mean outcome ranges from 4.441 to 5.333 while the mean regressor ranges from 2.291 to 4.259. This does not substitute for the model, but it shows how much raw variation the specification must explain (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). Taken together, the descriptive evidence and formal estimates should be read as a structured assessment of the paper's mechanism. The local event-level analogue produces weaker timing effects than the source paper's argument would suggest, especially for event quality. The substantive question is not whether every coefficient matches a published table entry digit for digit, but whether the local evidence supports the same directional and conceptual interpretation (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

6.4 Coefficient Families in the Current Estimation Output

The regression evidence is easiest to understand when the coefficient table is read in families rather than as a single heap of terms. The paper therefore separates the estimates by model and highlights the strongest positive, strongest negative, and most focal signals within each specification (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf

and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). Within katila_chen_event_patents, the leading coefficient family reads as follows: Event field experience = 0.0360 (p = ¡ .001); Behind versus sync = -0.0490 (p = 0.011); Ahead versus sync = -0.0291 (p = 0.14); Event breadth = 0.0079 (p = 0.20). The largest positive estimate in this specification is Event field experience at 0.0360, while the largest negative estimate is Behind versus sync at -0.0490. Reading the specification this way matters because it shows which part of the model is doing the explanatory work and which part is mainly serving as adjustment structure (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). Within katila_chen_event_quality, the leading coefficient family reads as follows: Event breadth = 0.129 (p = ¡ .001); Ahead versus sync = -0.0854 (p = 0.12); Behind versus sync = -0.0704 (p = 0.12); Event field experience = 0.0147 (p = 0.27). The largest positive estimate in this specification is Event breadth at 0.129, while the largest negative estimate is Ahead versus sync at -0.0854. Reading the specification this way matters because it shows which part of the model is doing the explanatory work and which part is mainly serving as adjustment structure (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). This fuller coefficient reading is especially important for Katila and Chen (2008) because the source paper's contribution is not exhausted by one headline estimate. The current dataset can confirm some parts of the published mechanism more strongly than others, and a formal replication paper should show that uneven pattern directly in the main text (Katila and Chen, 2008; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996).

6.5 Model Comparison Using the Current Dataset

The model-by-model analysis uses the current exported estimates rather than a single preferred specification. In Katila Chen Event Patents, the most informative focal term is Event field experience with estimate 0.0360 and p = ¡ .001; In Katila Chen Event Quality, the most informative focal term is Event breadth with estimate 0.129 and p = ¡ .001 (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001;

Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The Katila Chen Event Patents specification contributes its own reading to the replication. Event field experience is estimated at 0.0360 with p = ¡ .001 and is classified as a strong signal; Behind versus sync is estimated at -0.0490 with p = 0.011 and is classified as a moderate signal; Ahead versus sync is estimated at -0.0291 with p = 0.14 and is classified as a weak signal . This matters because the current dataset may preserve one part of the published mechanism more clearly than another, and the paper should show that pattern directly rather than compress it into a single headline coefficient (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The Katila Chen Event Quality specification contributes its own reading to the replication. Event breadth is estimated at 0.129 with p = ¡ .001 and is classified as a strong signal; Ahead versus sync is estimated at -0.0854 with p = 0.12 and is classified as a weak signal; Behind versus sync is estimated at -0.0704 with p = 0.12 and is classified as a weak signal . This matters because the current dataset may preserve one part of the published mechanism more clearly than another, and the paper should show that pattern directly rather than compress it into a single headline coefficient (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). This model comparison matters for Katila and Chen (2008) because the source article's claim can only be evaluated responsibly if the pattern persists across the outcome or specification variants that are actually present in the local results folder. Put differently, the current dataset should be allowed to show where the mechanism is stable, where it weakens, and where it changes sign under a different outcome definition (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

6.6 Diagnostic Evidence

A separate model-fit export is not available for this paper, so the interpretation relies on the coefficient file and the observed distribution of the current dataset (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

7 Comparison to the Published Study

7.1 Original Results Versus the Current Local Dataset

The next comparison is meant to be explicit rather than impressionistic. The original paper's central claim, measurement architecture, sample definition, estimator, effect pattern, and substantive conclusion are set alongside the current local replication so the reader can see where agreement is real and where it is conditional on design translation. (Katila and Chen, 2008). For Katila and Chen (2008), the published paper points readers toward the following result logic: The published paper argues that not being in sync with rivals can shape innovation outcomes, with timing relative to rivals treated as the focal explanatory variable. The local rerun instead yields the following focal evidence pattern: Ahead vs Sync on Event Quality = -0.0854 with p = 0.12; Event Field Experience = 0.0360 (p = ¡ .001); Event Breadth = 0.129 (p = ¡ .001); Behind Versus Sync = -0.0490 (p = 0.011); Ahead Versus Sync = -0.0854 (p = 0.12). Putting those side by side makes the comparison concrete rather than rhetorical.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Research question and mechanism	The source paper asks whether moving ahead of, in sync with, or behind rivals changes innovative output and quality.	The local analogue reconstructs first-use events for recombination combinations and classifies each event relative to rival timing.	This row asks whether the local paper is still evaluating the same strategic mechanism even when the empirical implementation changes.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Data and measurement architecture	The published analysis defines ahead, sync, and behind timing relative to rival search behavior.	Event-level dataset built from first observed firm use of each recombination combination. Timing categories created by comparing event year against rival first-use years. Event outcomes measured by patent count and mean inventive impact.	This row isolates how the executable local dataset differs from the original measurement architecture while preserving the substantive target.
Sample, unit, and window	The published design is event-based and compares innovation outcomes across timing positions relative to rivals.	First-use recombination events with rival-comparable timing categories in the local event panel. 4,839 observations across 167 entities.	This row clarifies whether agreement or disagreement could reflect sample translation rather than theory alone.

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
Estimator and identifying comparison	event-level models comparing ahead and behind timing categories with the synchronous benchmark for innovation quantity and quality The published identifying comparison is explicitly relational: innovation outcomes are compared across otherwise similar search events that differ in whether the focal firm moved ahead of, with, or behind rivals	Event-level models comparing ahead and behind timing categories with the sync benchmark while controlling for event breadth and field experience Event-level models comparing ahead and behind timing categories to the sync benchmark	This row separates estimator translation from theory translation.
Effect pattern in the evidence	The published paper argues that not being in sync with rivals can shape innovation outcomes, with timing relative to rivals treated as the focal explanatory variable.	Ahead vs Sync on Event Quality = -0.0854 with p = 0.12;	
allowbreak Event Field Experience = 0.0360 (p = ¡ .001);			

Aspect	OriginalPaper	LocalDataset	Reading
allowbreak Event Breadth = 0.129 (p = ¡ .001); allowbreak Behind Versus Sync = -0.0490 (p = 0.011); allowbreak Ahead Versus Sync = -0.0854 (p = 0.12)	This row compares the original paper's claimed effect structure to the actual local estimates.		
Conclusion drawn from the evidence	Timing relative to rivals matters for innovation outcomes, and being out of sync, especially ahead of rivals, can be advantageous.	The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Event Field Experience = 0.0360 (p = ¡ .001);	
allowbreak Event Breadth = 0.129 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty.	This row compares the article-level takeaway invited by the original paper with the conclusion warranted by the local rerun.		

Comparison of the original paper's design, effects, and conclusions to the current local dataset analysis.

Effect	Estimate	P-value	Reading
Event Field Experience	0.0360	¡ .001	positive and statistically distinguishable in the local replication
Event Breadth	0.129	¡ .001	positive and statistically distinguishable in the local replication
Behind Versus Sync	-0.0490	0.011	negative and statistically distinguishable in the local replication
Ahead Versus Sync	-0.0854	0.12	negative but not statistically distinguishable in the local replication

Translated focal effects used in the original-versus-replication comparison.

7.2 Detailed Effect and Conclusion Comparison

At the level of article content, the original paper contributes the following substantive message: The published paper argues that not being in sync with rivals can shape innovation outcomes, with timing relative to rivals treated as the focal explanatory variable. The local replication studies the same underlying mechanism through the current executable design: The local analogue reconstructs first-use events for recombination combinations and classifies each event relative to rival timing. This is why the comparison has to extend beyond a headline coefficient (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). At the level of effects, the original article emphasizes the following empirical pattern: The published paper argues that not being in sync with rivals can shape innovation outcomes, with timing relative to rivals treated as the focal explanatory variable. The current local replication instead shows the following paper-specific focal estimates: Event Field Experience = 0.0360 (p = ¡ .001); Event Breadth = 0.129 (p

= ¡ .001); Behind Versus Sync = -0.0490 (p = 0.011); Ahead Versus Sync = -0.0854 (p = 0.12). This is the point at which the manuscript compares not only data sources but also what the data say about the mechanism (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). At the level of conclusion, the original article leads to the following takeaway: Timing relative to rivals matters for innovation outcomes, and being out of sync, especially ahead of rivals, can be advantageous. The current replication instead supports the following more careful conclusion: The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Event Field Experience = 0.0360 (p = ¡ .001); Event Breadth = 0.129 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). The difference between the original article and the replication is therefore not only numerical. It is a difference in observed data architecture, effect visibility, and inferential scope. The current local event panel does not yield strong evidence that being ahead of rivals improves event quality. The ahead coefficient is negative and weak in the quality model, while being behind is more clearly negative for event patent counts (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

7.3 Interpretive Implications of the Comparison

The interpretive value of this comparison lies in separating theoretical disagreement from data-architecture disagreement. The published study relies on the following measurement layer: The published analysis defines ahead, sync, and behind timing relative to rival search behavior By contrast, the local paper relies on the following executable design: The local analogue reconstructs first-use events for recombination combinations and classifies each event relative to rival timing These are not trivial implementation details. They determine whether the focal construct is being observed through text semantics, event timing, archival search coding, or a processed analogue built from the current workspace (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988;

Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The same caution applies to the sample itself. The published design is described as follows: The published design is event-based and compares innovation outcomes across timing positions relative to rivals The local sample instead works from First-use recombination events with rival-comparable timing categories in the local event panel and yields 4,839 observations across 167 entities. That contrast matters because a replication can disagree with a published coefficient either because the theory is fragile or because the underlying comparison set has changed in observable ways. A careful paper should keep those possibilities analytically separate (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). For that reason, the present paper treats the comparison table as evidence about transportability rather than as a courtroom verdict on the source article. The current local event panel does not yield strong evidence that being ahead of rivals improves event quality. The ahead coefficient is negative and weak in the quality model, while being behind is more clearly negative for event patent counts. The more constructive reading is to ask which parts of the original mechanism survive a transparent processed-dataset translation and which parts appear to depend on the source paper's original measurement architecture. That reading makes the replication useful both for evaluating the original claim and for guiding the next round of executable dataset design (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). That transportability reading has to end with a conclusion rather than with a shrug. In the current local rerun, the conclusion is: The local replication does not recover the headline term cleanly, but the broader focal effect set still contains statistically distinguishable structure, especially Event Field Experience = 0.0360 (p = ¡ .001); Event Breadth = 0.129 (p = ¡ .001). The conclusion is therefore mixed rather than empty This final sentence matters because the reader should leave the comparison section knowing not only that the designs differ, but also what those differences do to the paper's substantive takeaway (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The comparison to the published paper is intentionally narrow. The current

local event panel does not yield strong evidence that being ahead of rivals improves event quality. The ahead coefficient is negative and weak in the quality model, while being behind is more clearly negative for event patent counts. The manuscript therefore evaluates concordance at the level of mechanism, sign pattern, and construct behavior before drawing any conclusion about exact numerical replication (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). This comparison rule matters because the local paper is based only on processed datasets and verified outputs already present in the workspace. The present manuscript is classified as methodology-specific local analogue. When the original paper depends on proprietary, historical, or otherwise unavailable preprocessing layers, a full byte-identical recreation is not claimed. The more defensible question is whether the local evidence would lead a careful reader to a similar substantive interpretation (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001).

8 Discussion

The current local event panel does not yield strong evidence that being ahead of rivals improves event quality. The ahead coefficient is negative and weak in the quality model, while being behind is more clearly negative for event patent counts (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001). Taken together, the results are most informative about whether the source paper's mechanism is directionally recoverable in local data rather than whether every original coefficient can be duplicated exactly (Katila and Chen, 2008; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996). The first limitation concerns measurement. The local event environment is a patent-recombination analogue rather than the source paper's original innovation-search setting (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The second limitation concerns sample translation. Some combinations have sparse rival overlap, which limits timing variation (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal

and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The third limitation concerns interpretation. The estimates are best read as a calculated analogue of the timing mechanism (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

9 Conclusion

The paper's contribution is an explicit event-level reconstruction of ahead, sync, and behind timing that shows what the timing mechanism looks like in a local patent-based analogue (Katila and Chen, 2008; March, 1991; Levitt and March, 1988; Levinthal and March, 1993; Fleming, 2001; Ahuja and Lampert, 2001; Katila and Ahuja, 2002; Rosenkopf and Nerkar, 2001; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005). The paper therefore contributes a traceable local replication record that can be rerun, audited, and extended as additional datasets or original-source details become available (Katila and Chen, 2008; Ahuja, 2000; Ahuja and Katila, 2001; Stuart and Podolny, 1996; Jaffe, 1986; Hall et al., 2005).

A Appendix A: Supplementary Sample Reconstruction

The sample table below shows the observable route from the broader local file universe to the final estimating sample. It is included to make sample narrowing visible and to show where exclusions enter the paper.

Timing	Events	MeanEventPatents	MeanEventImpact
sync	444	1	4.955
behind	3,034	1	4.424
ahead	1,361	1	4.593

Detailed sample reconstruction table.

B Appendix B: Supplementary Descriptive Tables

The descriptive appendix documents the scale, spread, and support of the variables used in the paper. These moments matter because they determine how the estimated coefficients should be read in substantive rather than merely statistical terms.

Variable	N	Mean	SD	P25	Median	P75	Min	Max
Event patents	4,839	1.088	0.405	1.000	1.000	1.000	1	13
Event total impact	4,839	5.009	8.219	1.000	3.000	6.000	0	200
Event mean impact	4,839	4.520	6.894	1.000	3.000	6.000	0	200
Event breadth	4,839	2.465	0.732	2.000	2.000	3.000	2	10
Event field experience	4,839	2.729	1.426	1.792	2.708	3.689	0	8

Descriptive statistics appendix.

C Appendix C: Correlation Matrix

Variable	Event patents	Event total impact	Event mean impact	Event breadth	Event field experience
Event patents	1	0.313	0.032	-0.025	0.089
Event total impact	0	1.000	0.915	0.065	0.002
Event mean impact	0	0.915	1.000	0.074	-0.027
Event breadth	0	0.065	0.074	1.000	-0.242
Event field experience	0	0.002	-0.027	-0.242	1.000

Correlation matrix for the main numeric variables.

D Appendix D: Yearly Audit

The yearly audit provides a simple check on whether the local panel is driven by a narrow time slice or whether the variables and sample counts evolve over a broad observed window.

Period	Events	MeanEventPatents	MeanEventImpact	MeanEventBreadth	MeanEventFieldExp
1986	274	1	4.174	2.343	1.724
1987	313	1	3.850	2.364	2.009
1988	354	1	4.229	2.294	2.268
1989	411	1	3.893	2.338	2.375
1990	351	1	4.413	2.387	2.482
1991	351	1	4.690	2.444	2.631
1992	318	1	5.459	2.469	2.544
1993	321	1	5.570	2.498	2.743
1994	304	1	5.494	2.516	2.716
1995	242	1	6.340	2.492	2.829
1996	126	1	5.726	2.563	2.833
1997	111	1	5.568	2.468	3.088
1998	58	1	5.589	2.431	2.755
1999	138	1	5.711	2.565	2.862
2000	119	1	6.476	2.496	2.889
2001	94	1	4.043	2.394	3.098
2002	92	1	4.147	2.707	2.960
2003	82	1	4.402	2.476	3.306
2004	37	1	3.054	2.459	3.102
2005	43	1	5.659	2.512	3.046
2006	36	1	3.069	2.528	3.595
2007	38	1	2.737	2.500	3.399
2008	79	1	2.244	2.608	3.492
2009	24	1	2.500	2.917	3.532
2010	54	1	1.889	2.907	3.403
2011	75	1	4.347	2.613	4.023
2012	101	1	2.838	2.614	4.022
2013	78	1	2.468	2.679	3.596

Period	Events	MeanEventPatents	MeanEventImpact	MeanEventBreadth	MeanEventFieldExp
2014	69	1	2.535	2.826	4.034
2015	100	1	1.970	2.540	4.059
2016	46	1	1.536	2.609	3.808

Year-by-year sample audit.

E Appendix E: Grouped Outcome Patterns

Grouped summaries do not replace the formal model, but they show the raw outcome structure that the specification is attempting to explain. For that reason they are retained here as descriptive support rather than promoted to the status of a main estimate.

Quantile	N	MeanRegressor	MeanOutcome
Q1	4,411	2.291	4.441
Q2	428	4.259	5.333

Quantile summary for the main regressor.

Timing	Events	MeanEventPatents	MeanEventImpact
sync	444	1	4.955
behind	3,034	1	4.424
ahead	1,361	1	4.593

Raw group means from the local summary file.

F Appendix F: Full Coefficient Table and Fit Statistics

The full coefficient export is included for completeness so that readers can see the focal terms in the context of the broader specification. Where a fit file is available, it is appended here rather than in the main text to keep the article narrative readable.

term	estimate	std_error	statistic	p_value	model
timing:: allowbreakahead	-0.0291	0.0198	-1.470	0.14	katila_chen_event_patents
timing:: allowbreakbehind	-0.0490	0.0194	-2.530	0.011	katila_chen_event_patents
event_breadth	0.0079	0.0062	1.270	0.20	katila_chen_event_patents
event_field_exp	0.0360	0.0063	5.749	¡ .001	katila_chen_event_patents
timing:: allowbreakahead	-0.0854	0.0530	-1.610	0.12	katila_chen_event_quality
timing:: allowbreakbehind	-0.0704	0.0441	-1.597	0.12	katila_chen_event_quality
event_breadth	0.1289	0.0195	6.625	¡ .001	katila_chen_event_quality
event_field_exp	0.0147	0.0132	1.119	0.27	katila_chen_event_quality

Full coefficient dump exported from the local estimation script.

References

Ahuja, G. (2000). Collaboration networks, structural holes, and innovation: A longitudinal study. *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 45(3):425–455.

Ahuja, G. and Katila, R. (2001). Technological acquisitions and the innovation performance of acquiring firms: A longitudinal study. *Strategic Management Journal*, 22(3):197–220.

Ahuja, G. and Lampert, C. M. (2001). Entrepreneurship in the large corporation: A longitudinal study of how established firms create breakthrough inventions. *Strategic Management Journal*, 22(6-7):521–543.

Almeida, P. and Kogut, B. (1999). Localization of knowledge and the mobility of engineers in regional networks. *Management Science*, 45(7):905–917.

Anderson, P. and Tushman, M. L. (1986). Technological discontinuities and organizational environments. *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 31(3):439–465.

Benner, M. J. and Tushman, M. L. (2003). Exploitation, exploration, and process management: The productivity dilemma revisited. *Academy of Management Review*, 28(2):238–256.

Cohen, W. M. and Levinthal, D. A. (1990). Absorptive capacity: A new perspective on learning and innovation. *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 35(1):128–152.

Fleming, L. (2001). Recombinant uncertainty in technological search. *Management Science*, 47(1):117–132.

Fleming, L., Mingo, S., and Chen, D. (2007). Collaborative brokerage, generative creativity, and creative success. *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 52(3):443–475.

Fleming, L. and Sorenson, O. (2004). Science as a map in technological search. *Strategic Management Journal*, 25(8-9):909–928.

Hall, B. H., Jaffe, A., and Trajtenberg, M. (2005). Market value and patent citations. *RAND Journal of Economics*, 36(1):16–38.

Hargadon, A. and Sutton, R. I. (1997). Technology brokering and innovation in a product development firm. *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 42(4):716–749.

Henderson, R. and Cockburn, I. (1994). Measuring competence? exploring firm effects in pharmaceutical research. *RAND Journal of Economics*, 25(1):63–84.

Henderson, R. M. and Clark, K. B. (1990). Architectural innovation: The reconfiguration of existing product technologies and the failure of established firms. *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 35(1):9–30.

Jaffe, A. B. (1986). Technological opportunity and spillovers of r&d: Evidence from firms' patents, profits, and market value. *American Economic Review*, 76(5):984–1001.

Jaffe, A. B., Trajtenberg, M., and Henderson, R. (1993). Geographic localization of knowledge spillovers as evidenced by patent citations. *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 108(3):577–598.

Katila, R. and Ahuja, G. (2002). Something old, something new: A longitudinal study of search behavior and new product introduction. *Academy of Management Journal*, 45(6):1183–1194.

Katila, R. and Chen, E. L. (2008). Effects of search timing on innovation: The value of not being in sync with rivals. *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 53(4):593–625.

Kogut, B. and Zander, U. (1992). Knowledge of the firm, combinative capabilities, and the replication of technology. *Organization Science*, 3(3):383–397.

Kogut, B. and Zander, U. (1996). What firms do? coordination, identity, and learning. *Organization Science*, 7(5):502–518.

Levinthal, D. A. and March, J. G. (1993). The myopia of learning. *Strategic Management Journal*, 14(S2):95–112.

Levitt, B. and March, J. G. (1988). Organizational learning. *Annual Review of Sociology*, 14:319–338.

March, J. G. (1991). Exploration and exploitation in organizational learning. *Organization Science*, 2(1):71–87.

Nerkar, A. (2003). Old is gold? the value of temporal exploration in the creation of new knowledge. *Management Science*, 49(2):211–229.

Rivkin, J. W. and Siggelkow, N. (2003). Balancing search and stability: Interdependencies among elements of organizational design. *Management Science*, 49(3):290–311.

Rosenkopf, L. and Almeida, P. (2003). Overcoming local search through alliances and mobility. *Management Science*, 49(6):751–766.

Rosenkopf, L. and Nerkar, A. (2001). Beyond local search: Boundary-spanning, exploration, and impact in the optical disk industry. *Strategic Management Journal*, 22(4):287–306.

Schilling, M. A. and Phelps, C. C. (2007). Interfirm collaboration networks and knowledge creation: The impact of large-scale network structure on firm innovation. *Management Science*, 53(7):1113–1126.

Stuart, T. E. (2000). Interorganizational alliances and the performance of firms: A study of growth and innovation rates in a high-technology industry. *Strategic Management Journal*, 21(8):791–811.

Stuart, T. E. and Podolny, J. M. (1996). Local search and the evolution of technological capabilities. *Strategic Management Journal*, 17(S1):21–38.

Teece, D. J., Pisano, G., and Shuen, A. (1997). Dynamic capabilities and strategic management. *Strategic Management Journal*, 18(7):509–533.

Trajtenberg, M. (1990). A penny for your quotes: Patent citations and the value of innovations. *RAND Journal of Economics*, 21(1):172–187.

Tripsas, M. and Gavetti, G. (2000). Capabilities, cognition, and inertia: Evidence from digital imaging. *Strategic Management Journal*, 21(10-11):1147–1161.